



# KARLOVY VARY RACE PREVIEW

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Elite Analysis · September 12 – 13, 2026

USA Triathlon High Performance

# Race Week Schedule

Karlovy Vary



September 12 – 13, 2026 • Lake Rolava (T1) + Theatre Square (T2), Karlovy Vary (CEST, UTC+2)

Sat • Sep 12  
Familiarisation & Briefing

|               |                                                         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 07:30 – 09:30 | Athletes Lounge open — Lake Rolava                      |
| 07:45 – 08:45 | Swim course familiarisation — Lake Rolava               |
| 09:00         | Bike escorted familiarisation                           |
| 16:00 – 16:30 | ★ Mandatory Elite Athletes briefing — Spa Hotel Thermal |

Sun • Sep 13 — Women  
WTCS RACE DAY (AM)

|               |                                                            |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 08:00 – 08:30 | Elite Women — TA2 check-in (Theatre Square)                |
| 08:30 – 09:30 | Elite Women — Athletes Lounge check-in (re-entry to 09:50) |
| 08:45 – 09:45 | Elite Women — TA1 check-in (Lake Rolava)                   |
| 09:00 – 09:45 | Elite Women — Swim warm-up                                 |
| 09:50 – 09:59 | Elite Women — Line-up and presentation                     |
| 10:00         | ★ ELITE WOMEN RACE START                                   |
| 12:10 / 12:25 | Women awards + Chocolate ceremony — Theatre Square         |

Sun • Sep 13 — Men  
WTCS RACE DAY (PM)

|               |                                                  |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 13:00 – 13:30 | Elite Men — TA2 check-in (Theatre Square)        |
| 13:30 – 14:30 | Elite Men — Athletes Lounge check-in             |
| 13:45 – 14:45 | Elite Men — TA1 check-in (Lake Rolava)           |
| 14:00 – 14:45 | Elite Men — Swim warm-up                         |
| 14:50 – 14:59 | Elite Men — Line-up and presentation             |
| 15:00         | ★ ELITE MEN RACE START                           |
| 17:10 / 17:25 | Men awards + Chocolate ceremony — Theatre Square |

Times Lake Rolava (T1) + Theatre Square (T2), Karlovy Vary (CEST, UTC+2). Schedule confirmed from World Triathlon race-info page / athlete guide; subject to organiser updates.

# Key Course Differentiators

Karlovy Vary



## KARLOVY VARY

WTCS Karlovy Vary returns to the Czech spa town for its second year at Championship Series level (World Cup 2017–2024, WTCS from 2025). This is a standard-distance, *two-transition* race: a 1.5 km two-lap swim in Lake Rolava with an Australian exit, a 6.5 km approach into 7 difficult 4.9 km bike laps (40.8 km, with a Cat 4, 1.3 mile climb averaging 4.1%, part cobbled), then a 4-lap 10 km run through the city centre from Theatre Square. The course is the same as the previous year for those racing here again. A technical swim with multiples turns along with a difficult hilly bike is the story here with the course offering strong swim, bikers the opportunity to separate the field and gap the strong runners.

### COURSE FEATURES

- 1.5 km swim (2 x 750 m) in Lake Rolava. Pontoon start, Australian exit, and navigation heavy. Wetsuit ruling has flipped year to year. Overall, the highly technical course favors strong swimmers
- 40.8 km bike: 6.5 km approach + 7 x 4.9 km laps. Each lap contains significant cat 4 climb averaging 4.1% grade over 1.35 miles. Cobble section on each lap too
- 10 km run (4 x 2.5 km) through the spa-town centre. Running surface is a mix between asphalt/pavement.
- Two transitions (T1 Lake Rolava to T2 Theatre Square) and split start times: Women 10:00, Men 15:00.

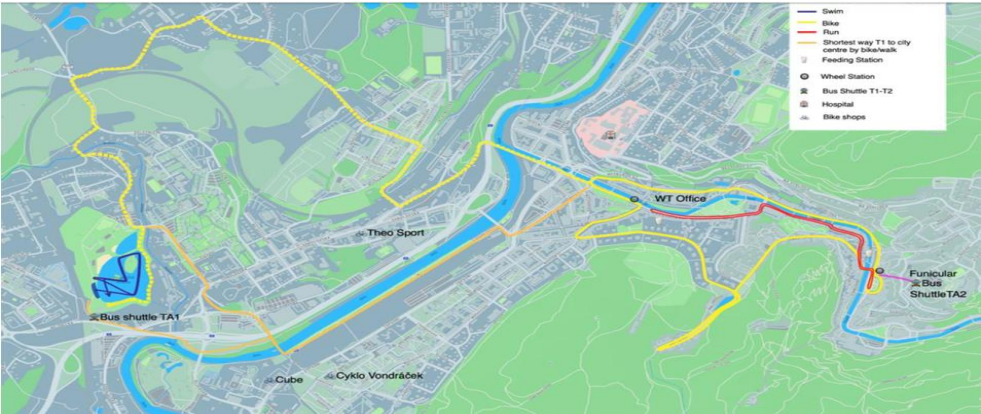
### COURSE AT A GLANCE

|            |                           |
|------------|---------------------------|
| Swim:      | 1.5 km – 2 laps × 750 m   |
| Bike:      | 40.8 km – 7 laps × 4.9 km |
| Run:       | 10 km – 4 laps × 2.5 km   |
| Format:    | Standard Triathlon (WTCS) |
| Bike Laps: | 7                         |
| Run Laps:  | 4                         |

### QUICK LINKS

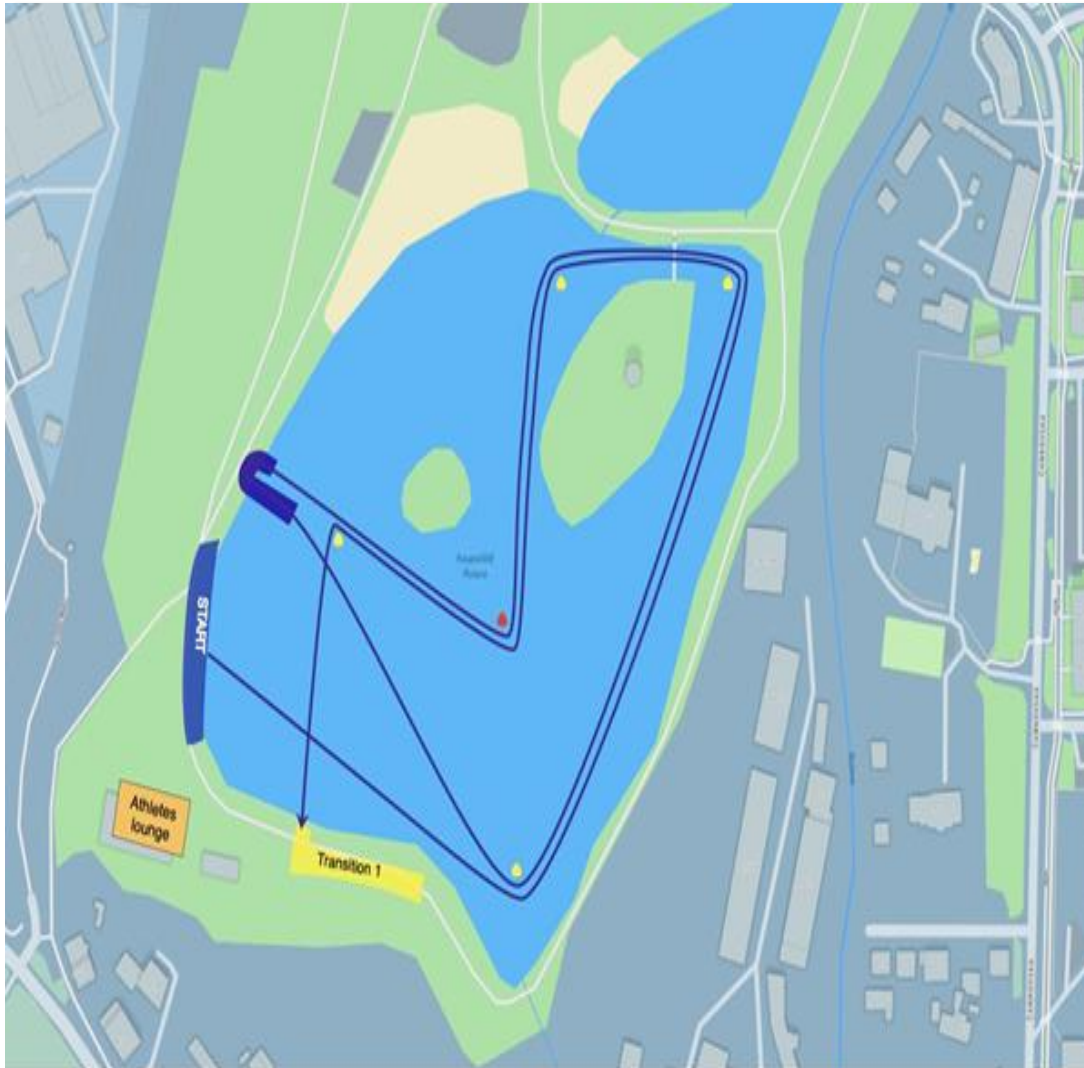
Current Race Info:

[Race Info | 2026 WTCS Karlovy Vary](#)



# Swim Course Profile

Karlovy Vary



**1.5 km • 2 × 750 m**

*Freshwater lake. Sheltered, island-lined course*

Distance

**1.5 km**

Layout

**Lake Rolava**

Start

**Pontoon start**

Water Temp

**18.0–20.0 °C**

Wetsuit

**Likely**

Lap Count

**2**

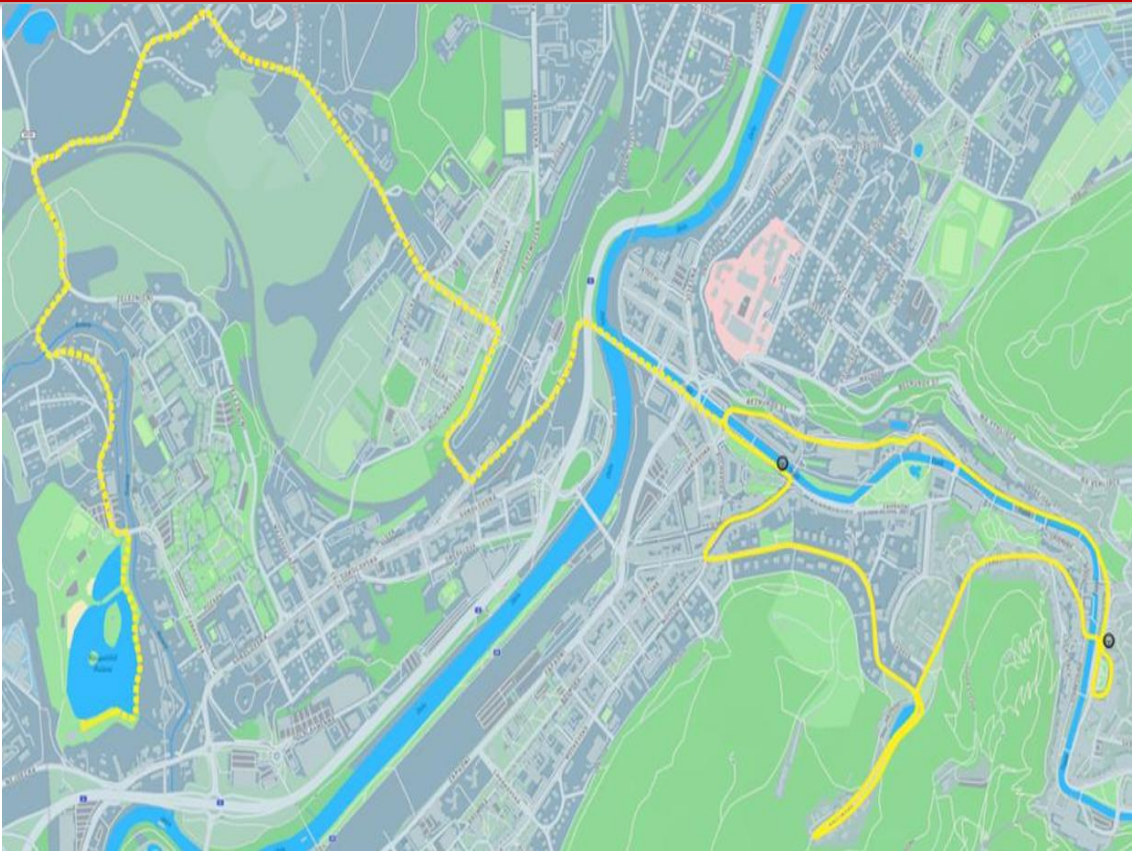
## Tactical Notes

- 2 × 750 m anti-clockwise laps in Lake Rolava. Pontoon start with a hard 205 m opening leg to the first turn buoy. Swim contains an Australian exit at different point than the start. Athletes will run the wooden pier at the end of lap 1 dive back and take a different route to the first buoy
- The swim is navigation-heavy with athletes needing to manage swimming behind the big island, under the bridge, left between the big and small islands, then right to the pier. The water is sheltered with should help make sighting easier than in surf conditions.
- Wetsuit ruling has flipped year to year (18–19 °C most editions, 23–25 °C in 2024) — bring both setups
- Swim exits into TA1 at Lake Rolava; last-minute gear is transported by the LOC to the finish area in the city



# Bike Course Profile

Karlovy Vary



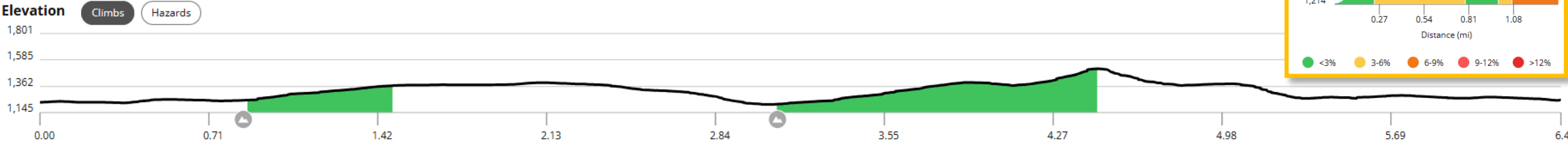
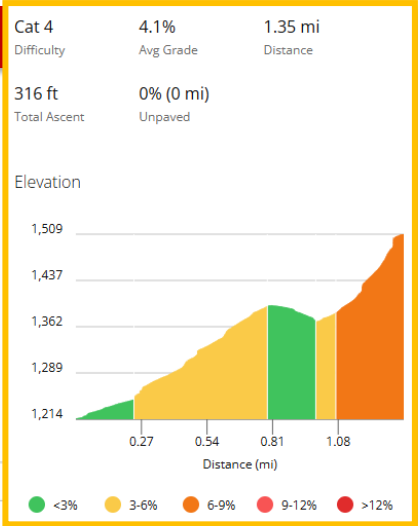
40.8 km • 7 × 4.9 km loops

80% asphalt / 20% pavement (cobble)

|                                                  |                           |                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Elevation / Lap<br>~340 / lap +220 ft on lead in | Total Climb<br>~ 2,600 ft | Avg Grade<br>~4% (on main climb) |
| Max Climb Grade<br>6-9%                          | Wind<br>Sheltered Valley  | Loops<br>7 × 4.9 km              |

## Tactical Implications

- 6.5 km approach from Lake Rolava, then 7 technically challenging laps of 4.9 km = 40.8 km total
- THE defining feature: A 1.35 mile climb repeated 7 time. Average 4.1% and gains 316 ft.
- Corrugated terrain, 80% asphalt / 20% pavement. Some cobbled sections add additional complexity, check tyre pressure and bottles
- One of the hardest bike courses on the circuit: expect the lead group to shrink substantially rather than a bunch finish



# Run Course Profile

Karlovy Vary



10.0 km • 4 × 2.5 km

Mixed asphalt and pavement

Distance

10.0 km

Lap Structure

4 × 2.5 km

Total Climb

~ 400 ft (100 ft / lap)

Avg Grade

0-3%

Max ▲ / ▼

Not published

Heat Risk

LOW

## Tactical Notes

- 4 laps of 2.5 km (10 km) through the Karlovy Vary spa-town centre. Out of TA2 at Theatre Square
- Mixed asphalt and pavement surface.
- Mid-September Czech conditions: mild and often cool (historic race-day air 14–27 °C)
- After a brutally selective bike, the run is usually contested by a much-reduced front group

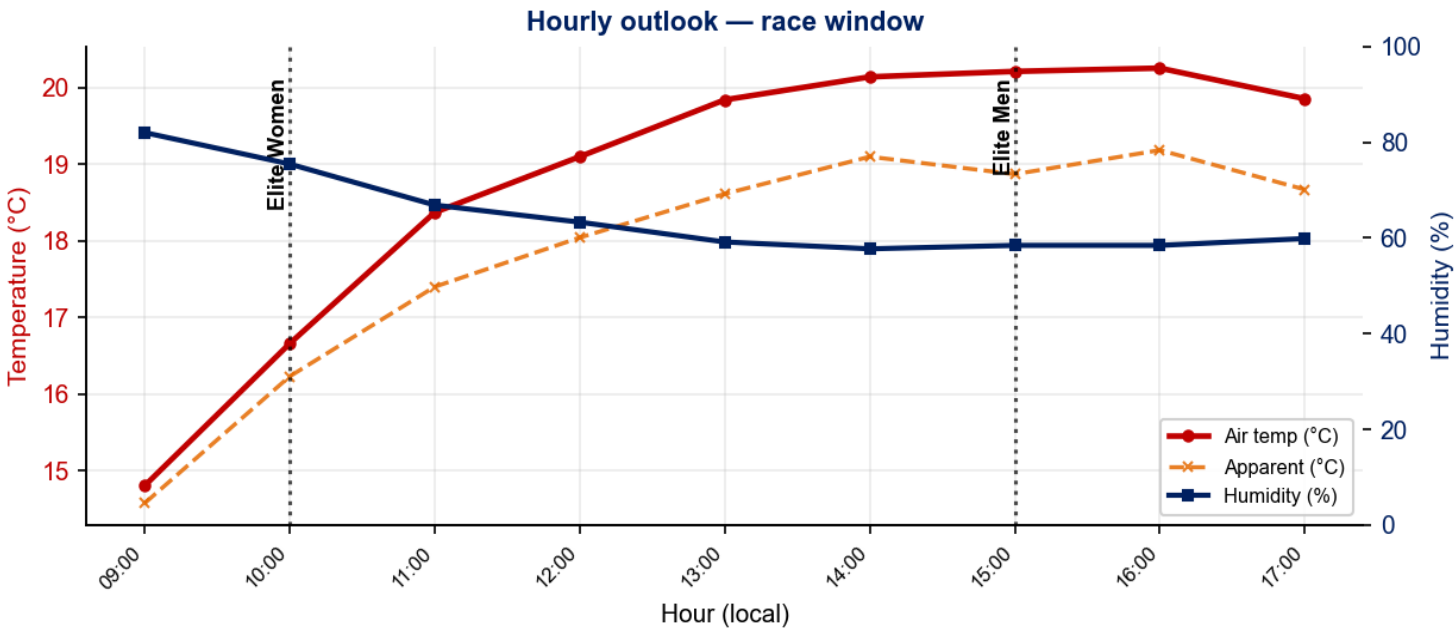


# Race-Day Weather Outlook

Karlovy Vary



2026-09-13 • Historical climatology (same calendar day, 7-year mean)



| Elite Women — 10:00    |                            |                    |
|------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------|
| Temperature<br>18.0 °C | Apparent / Heat<br>17.2 °C | Humidity<br>69%    |
| Wind<br>11.1 km/h      | UV peak<br>—               | Heat Stress<br>LOW |

| Elite Men — 15:00      |                            |                    |
|------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------|
| Temperature<br>20.1 °C | Apparent / Heat<br>18.9 °C | Humidity<br>59%    |
| Wind<br>11.9 km/h      | UV peak<br>—               | Heat Stress<br>LOW |

## Hydration & Cooling Cues

- Cool to mild outlook. Standard fluid plan (~500 ml/h)
- Men's race runs 2.1 °C hotter than women's. Heavier cooling kit may be required for the 15:00 start

Data source: Open-Meteo. Historical Race Conditions slide shows what actually happened in prior years.

# Travel & Arrival Load

Denver, CO to Karlovy Vary race week



## Core travel read

Fly Denver to Prague (PRG). Roughly 13–15 h door-to-door and a +8 h shift (MDT to CEST). From Prague it is a ~2 h ground transfer to Karlovy Vary (~125 km). The LOC provides a FREE bus transfer for elite athletes and coaches (bike included), but you must email flights to [transfer@citytriathlon.cz](mailto:transfer@citytriathlon.cz) before 31 Aug 2026 or it becomes 20 EUR a person each way.

**Primary route**  
**DEN → PRG**

*1-stop, overnight*

**Flight time**  
**~13–15 h**

*via LHR / FRA / AMS*

**Time zones**  
**+8 h**

*Czechia ahead of Denver*

**Airport Transfer**  
**PRG → Karlovy Vary**

*Free LOC bus (register!)*

**Transfer Distance**  
**~125 km / ~2 h**

*Coach transfer*

## Accommodation / Venue Logistics Read

- Briefing is at the Spa Hotel Thermal (Sat 12 Sep, 16:00–16:30)
- FREE LOC bus PRG to Karlovy Vary: email arrival time + flight number to [transfer@citytriathlon.cz](mailto:transfer@citytriathlon.cz) before 31 Aug 2026.
- Private LOC transfer if you miss the deadline: 140 EUR for 1–3 people, 180 EUR for 4–7. Extra escort staff 20 EUR per person per journey.
- Race-weekend shuttle runs between Divadelní náměstí (T2) and Lake Rolava (T1). About 20 min, with a funicular link at the Imperial stop.
- Two-transition race: TA2 checks in first (city), then TA1 at the lake.
- Free daily 2 h pool access at Mattoni Aréna and run track at AC Start stadium. Bring photo ID.

## Food / Grocery Options

- Karlovy Vary is a compact spa town. Supermarkets (Billa, Albert, Lidl, Tesco) are an easy walk or short bus from the centre.
- Tap water is safe throughout Czechia; the town's famous mineral springs are drinkable but heavily mineralized. Do not utilize prior to the race.
- Czech restaurant staples run heavy (dumplings, pork, sauces). Identify a couple of lighter pasta-and-rice options early in the week.
- Split start times (W 10:00 / M 15:00) mean very different fueling timelines. Men will need to plan out race day meals more carefully



# Environmental Risk Profile

Karlovy Vary



RACE-DAY WEATHER (10:00–17:00 local)

| Year | Date   | Air Temp | Humidity | Wind km/h | Precip mm |
|------|--------|----------|----------|-----------|-----------|
| 2016 | Aug 28 | 25.8     | 52%      | 8         | 0.0       |
| 2017 | Sep 03 | 14.0     | 59%      | 8         | 0.0       |
| 2018 | Sep 01 | 15.8     | 60%      | 15        | 0.0       |
| 2019 | Aug 25 | 24.5     | 59%      | 13        | 0.0       |
| 2020 | Sep 13 | 21.8     | 50%      | 7         | 0.0       |
| 2021 | Sep 11 | 18.8     | 81%      | 10        | 0.1       |
| 2022 | Sep 11 | 16.9     | 60%      | 12        | 0.1       |
| 2023 | Sep 10 | 27       | 48%      | 4         | 0.0       |
| 2024 | Sep 08 | 27.5     | 46%      | 8         | 0.0       |
| 2025 | Sep 14 | 19.3     | 81%      | 13        | 0.6       |

AIR QUALITY (Open-Meteo archive)

| Year | PM2.5 | EU AQI | UV Index | Risk     |
|------|-------|--------|----------|----------|
| 2016 | 16.8  | 51     | —        | Moderate |
| 2017 | 6.5   | 27     | —        | Fair     |
| 2018 | 9.5   | 24     | —        | Fair     |
| 2019 | 15.7  | 46     | —        | Moderate |
| 2020 | 11.3  | 39     | —        | Fair     |
| 2021 | 8.9   | 26     | —        | Fair     |
| 2022 | 6.6   | 26     | 1.3      | Fair     |
| 2023 | 11.8  | 53     | 3.7      | Moderate |
| 2024 | 6.7   | 33     | 3.3      | Fair     |
| 2025 | 1.9   | 22     | 1.3      | Fair     |

# Who to Watch — Karlov Vary Race Week



## ELITE MEN

### Top 10 Ranked on Startlist

| Rank | Athlete                 | Points |
|------|-------------------------|--------|
| 2    | Miguel Hidalgo          | 6,742  |
| 3    | Vasco Vilaca            | 6,632  |
| 4    | Henry Graf              | 6,009  |
| 5    | Csongor Lehmann         | 5,281  |
| 6    | David Cantero Del Campo | 5,092  |
| 8    | Dorian Coninx           | 4,423  |
| 9    | Ricardo Batista         | 4,055  |
| 10   | Charles Paquet          | 3,998  |
| 12   | Oliver Conway           | 3,682  |
| 15   | Tjebbe Kaindl           | 3,293  |

### Returning Podium Athletes on Startlist

1. **Henry Graf** (01:49:22)
2. Miguel Hidalgo (01:49:29)
3. Csongor Lehmann (01:49:46)

## ELITE WOMEN

### Top 10 Ranked on Startlist

| Rank | Athlete              | Points |
|------|----------------------|--------|
| 1    | Beth Potter          | 7,276  |
| 2    | Lisa Tertsch         | 7,270  |
| 4    | Jeanne Lehair        | 6,306  |
| 6    | Cassandre Beaugrand  | 5,391  |
| 7    | Jolien Vermeylen     | 5,167  |
| 9    | Taylor Spivey        | 5,091  |
| 10   | Diana Isakova        | 4,750  |
| 11   | Tanja Neubert        | 4,583  |
| 12   | Bianca Seregini      | 4,437  |
| 13   | Georgia Taylor-Brown | 3,728  |

### Returning Podium Athletes on Startlist

1. **Beth Potter** (02:02:12)
2. Taylor Spivey (02:02:25)
3. Lisa Tertsch (02:03:07)

*Rankings = current World Triathlon rankings snapshot; startlist intersect uses program\_entries when available.*

# Top Swim Threats

Karlovy Vary



Ranked by Lead Pack % (within 15 s of swim leader — robust to course speed) • EWMA swim split (span-5) shown per distance; Standard = this race • WTCS / World Cup / Continental, last 4 yrs

| ELITE MEN |                    |        |          |            |         | ELITE WOMEN |                     |        |          |            |         |
|-----------|--------------------|--------|----------|------------|---------|-------------|---------------------|--------|----------|------------|---------|
| #         | Athlete            | Lead % | EWMA Spr | EWMA Std ▸ | Spr/Std | #           | Athlete             | Lead % | EWMA Spr | EWMA Std ▸ | Spr/Std |
| 1         | Alessio Crociani   | 100%   | 8:39     | 17:19      | 17/4    | 1           | Bianca Seregni      | 93%    | 9:02     | 19:03      | 8/20    |
| 2         | Dorian Coninx      | 100%   | 8:58     | 17:26      | 5/9     | 2           | Cassandre Beaugrand | 87%    | 9:50     | 19:42      | 5/10    |
| 3         | Márk Dévay         | 97%    | 8:50     | 17:12      | 9/24    | 3           | Olivia Mathias      | 78%    | 9:45     | 18:58      | 13/10   |
| 4         | Miguel Tiago Silva | 95%    | 8:58     | 17:30      | 8/13    | 4           | Erin McConnell      | 77%    | 9:28     | —          | 13/0    |
| 5         | Henry Graf         | 88%    | 8:56     | 17:31      | 11/5    | 5           | Sophia Howell       | 74%    | 9:49     | 19:46      | 26/8    |
| 6         | Csongor Lehmann    | 86%    | 8:37     | 17:27      | 5/16    | 6           | Márta Kropkó        | 73%    | 9:38     | 18:46      | 12/10   |
| 7         | Tayler Reid        | 85%    | 8:51     | 17:11      | 13/14   | 7           | Jolien Vermeylen    | 72%    | 9:07     | 18:41      | 18/18   |
| 8         | Max Stapley        | 85%    | 8:50     | 17:38      | 10/10   | 8           | Taylor Spivey       | 68%    | 9:44     | 19:14      | 5/14    |
| 9         | Márton Kropkó      | 80%    | 8:56     | 17:47      | 2/3     | 9           | Sian Rainsley       | 67%    | 9:49     | 19:15      | 10/11   |
| 10        | Chase McQueen      | 77%    | 9:04     | 18:02      | 9/13    | 10          | Laura Lindemann     | 62%    | 9:44     | 19:26      | 4/12    |
| 11        | Jules Rethoret     | 69%    | 8:48     | 17:53      | 9/4     | 11          | Eva Goodisson       | 61%    | 10:25    | 19:33      | 17/11   |
| 12        | Kenji Nener        | 69%    | 8:55     | 18:16      | 11/15   | 12          | Beth Potter         | 60%    | 9:56     | 19:25      | 5/15    |
| 13        | Miguel Hidalgo     | 67%    | 8:50     | 17:39      | 7/14    | 13          | Therese Feuersinger | 57%    | 9:51     | 18:53      | 14/9    |
| 14        | Maciej Bruzdziak   | 67%    | 8:52     | 17:57      | 8/16    | 14          | Jessica Fullagar    | 56%    | 9:41     | 19:38      | 8/8     |

# USA World Rankings Snapshot

Karlovy Vary



As of 2026-08-17 • World Triathlon Rankings • Heading into Karlovy Vary • Race tier: WTCS

Max Points Available at this Race

|                  |                   |                  |                   |                   |                   |
|------------------|-------------------|------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Win<br>1,000 pts | Podium<br>855 pts | Top 5<br>732 pts | Top 10<br>495 pts | Top 15<br>335 pts | Top 20<br>227 pts |
|------------------|-------------------|------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|

ELITE MEN

| Rank | Athlete            | Points | Curr | Prev |
|------|--------------------|--------|------|------|
| 20   | John Reed          | 2,898  | 6    | 6    |
| 22   | Reese Vannerson    | 2,818  | 6    | 6    |
| 27   | Morgan Pearson     | 2,680  | 5    | 4    |
| 42   | Braxton Legg       | 2,442  | 6    | 6    |
| 49   | Sullivan Middaugh  | 2,296  | 6    | 6    |
| 53   | Seth Rider         | 2,243  | 6    | 4    |
| 67   | Keller Norland     | 1,989  | 6    | 6    |
| 80   | Blake Bullard      | 1,732  | 6    | 6    |
| 84   | Chase McQueen      | 1,708  | 6    | 6    |
| 108  | Porter Middaugh    | 1,513  | 6    | 6    |
| 113  | Darr Smith         | 1,452  | 6    | 6    |
| 116  | Zach Leachman      | 1,433  | 6    | —    |
| 178  | Carter Stuhlmacher | 1,025  | 6    | 3    |
| 282  | Cole Jamieson      | 600    | 4    | 2    |
| 362  | Isaac Lamprecht    | 417    | 6    | 2    |

ELITE WOMEN

| Rank | Athlete           | Points | Curr | Prev |
|------|-------------------|--------|------|------|
| 9    | Taylor Spivey     | 5,091  | 6    | 3    |
| 16   | Gina Sereno       | 3,205  | 6    | 6    |
| 26   | Danielle Orie     | 2,741  | 6    | 6    |
| 27   | Gwen Jorgensen    | 2,700  | 6    | 6    |
| 42   | Erika Ackerlund   | 2,341  | 6    | 6    |
| 46   | Kelly Wetteland   | 2,109  | 6    | 3    |
| 51   | Taylor Knibb      | 2,047  | 4    | —    |
| 60   | Naomi Ruff        | 1,968  | 6    | 6    |
| 89   | Kirsten Kasper    | 1,551  | 5    | 2    |
| 93   | Eleanor Beveridge | 1,479  | 6    | 5    |
| 100  | Joy Gill          | 1,421  | 6    | 6    |
| 113  | Rachel Werking    | 1,328  | 6    | 3    |
| 131  | Michelle Magnani  | 1,242  | 6    | 6    |
| 162  | Katie McCune      | 1,042  | 6    | 1    |
| 174  | Faith Duncan      | 940    | 6    | —    |



# Olympic Qualification Pace

Karlovy Vary



Paris 2024 OQR cutoff (30th): 3,626.69 pts ÷ 12-event cap = 302 pts / event on pace  
An athlete who averages ~302 pts per event across their best 12 events is on pace to clear the LA 2028 qualifying threshold.

FINISH POSITION AT EACH TIER THAT HITS 302-PT PACE

| Tier                      | Win pts | Last on-pace pos | First off-pace pos (pts) | Verdict |
|---------------------------|---------|------------------|--------------------------|---------|
| World Championship Series | 1000    | #16              | #17 (287 pts)            | Top 16  |
| World Cup                 | 500     | #7               | #8 (290 pts)             | Top 7   |

| USA MEN |                   |       |       |    |     |      |          | USA WOMEN |                   |       |       |    |     |      |          |
|---------|-------------------|-------|-------|----|-----|------|----------|-----------|-------------------|-------|-------|----|-----|------|----------|
| Rk      | Athlete           | Total | Races | On | Off | Pace | Proj @12 | Rk        | Athlete           | Total | Races | On | Off | Pace | Proj @12 |
| 12      | Sullivan Middaugh | 1,573 | 5     | 2  | 3   | 314  | 3,776    | 9         | Taylor Knibb      | 2,047 | 4     | 4  | 0   | 511  | 6,142    |
| 16      | Reese Vannerson   | 1,479 | 4     | 3  | 1   | 369  | 4,439    | 13        | Taylor Spivey     | 1,795 | 3     | 3  | 0   | 598  | 7,180    |
| 19      | Seth Rider        | 1,341 | 4     | 3  | 1   | 335  | 4,023    | 15        | Danielle Orie     | 1,646 | 5     | 3  | 2   | 329  | 3,951    |
| 20      | Braxton Legg      | 1,274 | 4     | 2  | 2   | 318  | 3,823    | 16        | Gina Sereno       | 1,450 | 4     | 2  | 2   | 362  | 4,351    |
| 24      | Keller Norland    | 1,087 | 3     | 2  | 1   | 362  | 4,349    | 28        | Kelly Wetteland   | 925   | 2     | 2  | 0   | 462  | 5,550    |
| 36      | Morgan Pearson    | 904   | 2     | 1  | 1   | 452  | 5,425    | 32        | Naomi Ruff        | 882   | 3     | 1  | 2   | 294  | 3,530    |
| 41      | Chase McQueen     | 816   | 4     | 1  | 3   | 204  | 2,450    | 45        | Erika Ackerlund   | 720   | 3     | 1  | 2   | 240  | 2,882    |
| 60      | John Reed         | 599   | 2     | 1  | 1   | 299  | 3,598    | 56        | Eleanor Beveridge | 567   | 3     | 0  | 3   | 189  | 2,269    |
| 66      | Blake Bullard     | 513   | 3     | 0  | 3   | 171  | 2,055    | 58        | Gwen Jorgensen    | 556   | 2     | 1  | 1   | 278  | 3,337    |
| 68      | Porter Middaugh   | 481   | 3     | 1  | 2   | 160  | 1,926    | 91        | Rachel Werking    | 271   | 2     | 0  | 2   | 135  | 1,629    |
| 107     | Zach Leachman     | 212   | 1     | 0  | 1   | 212  | 2,545    | 110       | Joy Gill          | 200   | 2     | 0  | 2   | 100  | 1,203    |

On = events scoring ≥ pace. Off = events < pace. Pace = total breakdown pts ÷ events raced. Proj @12 = current total + (avg pts × remaining events to cap); green if ≥ Paris cutoff. Cutoff estimate: Paris 2024 = 3,627 pts / 12 events = 302 pts/event. Tier positions use a geometric 0.925 points model. Source: World Triathlon rankings database.

# ELITE MEN

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# Race Overview — Elite Men

Karlovy Vary



## RACE HISTORY AT KARLOVY VARY

The Elite Men race at Karlovy Vary has been held 10 times in this analysis window (2016–2025). The event was previously part of the Continental Cup / World Cup calendar until being added to the series in 2025.

Last year, Henry Graf was able to leverage his strong bike skills to break up the field and separate himself from the strong runners which ultimately resulted in him holding off Hidalgo for the win.

Athletes competing this year should again expect the strong swim/bikers to leverage a technical swim and hilly bike course to break the field up and make this one of the hardest races on the circuit. Don't be surprised if a quarter of the field doesn't make it to the finish. 15 athletes were either lapped out or DNF'd in last years race, confirming the difficulty of the course.

## 3 KEYS TO SUCCESS

1

Course was short was year with the average time for the standard distance at 15:58. However when the course was on the World Cup circuit, the technical nature navigating the islands and Auzzie exit often strung out the field and resulted in less than 10 athletes coming out near the leader. Expect for strong swimmers to get out and try to break the pack before lap 1 ends.

2

Since the course has been changed to its current format the pack has often split up because of the hilly and demanding course profile. In the past 3 editions of the race the lead pack was condensed even further to small groups of 3, 5, and 1 riders, respectively. Expect for strong cyclists to attack the group and split the field up.

3

With the race being a WTCS last year and a slight course change, the 10K times were significantly faster than in previous years. Despite the difficult bike leg, average run times from 2025 were very similar to Yokohama with the difference from the two races only 1 second apart. Thus, if you can manage the hills on the bike, the flat run course should still suit fast runners the opportunity to close on the field.

# Results Summary — Elite Men

Karlovy Vary



| Year | Date   | Category                       | Field | DNF/LAP/<br>DNS | Winner     | Winner<br>Time | Air<br>Temp | Water<br>Temp | Swim<br>km | Bike<br>km | Run<br>km |
|------|--------|--------------------------------|-------|-----------------|------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|------------|------------|-----------|
| 2016 | Aug 28 | Continental Cup                | 49    | 24              | Brownlee   | 1:50:34        | 25.8        | —             | —          | —          | —         |
| 2017 | Sep 03 | World Cup                      | 50    | 12              | Iden       | 1:49:06        | 14.0        | —             | —          | —          | —         |
| 2018 | Sep 01 | World Cup                      | 62    | 12              | Polyanskiy | 1:52:22        | 15.8        | —             | —          | —          | —         |
| 2019 | Aug 25 | World Cup                      | 66    | 21              | Dickinson  | 1:56:11        | 24.5        | —             | —          | —          | —         |
| 2020 | Sep 13 | World Cup                      | 66    | 19              | Luis       | 1:52:14        | 21.8        | —             | —          | —          | —         |
| 2021 | Sep 11 | World Cup                      | 65    | 12              | Priester   | 1:53:31        | 18.8        | —             | —          | —          | —         |
| 2022 | Sep 11 | World Cup *                    | 66    | 15              | Lehmann    | 1:51:10        | 16.9        | —             | 1.50       | 40.8       | 10.0      |
| 2023 | Sep 10 | World Cup                      | 59    | 20              | Pearson    | 1:51:55        | 27          | 19.8          | 1.50       | 40.8       | 10.0      |
| 2024 | Sep 08 | World Cup *                    | 52    | 8               | Reed       | 1:54:24        | 27.5        | 24.9          | 1.50       | 40.8       | —         |
| 2025 | Sep 14 | World Championship<br>Series * | 51    | 15              | Graf       | 1:49:22        | 19.3        | 18.0          | 1.50       | 40.8       | 10.0      |

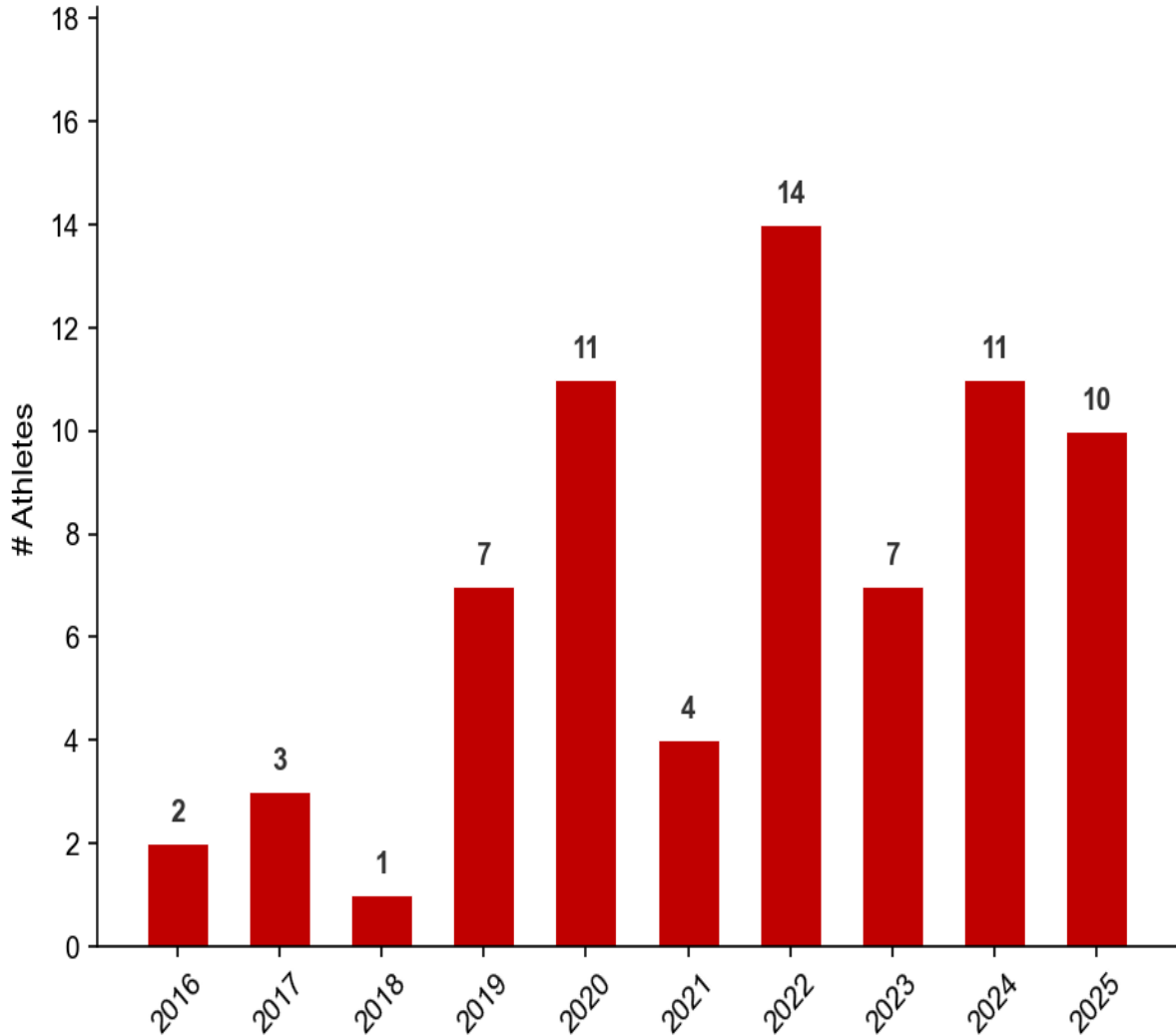
\* Course distance changed vs. prior year

# Swim Exit Dynamics — Elite Men

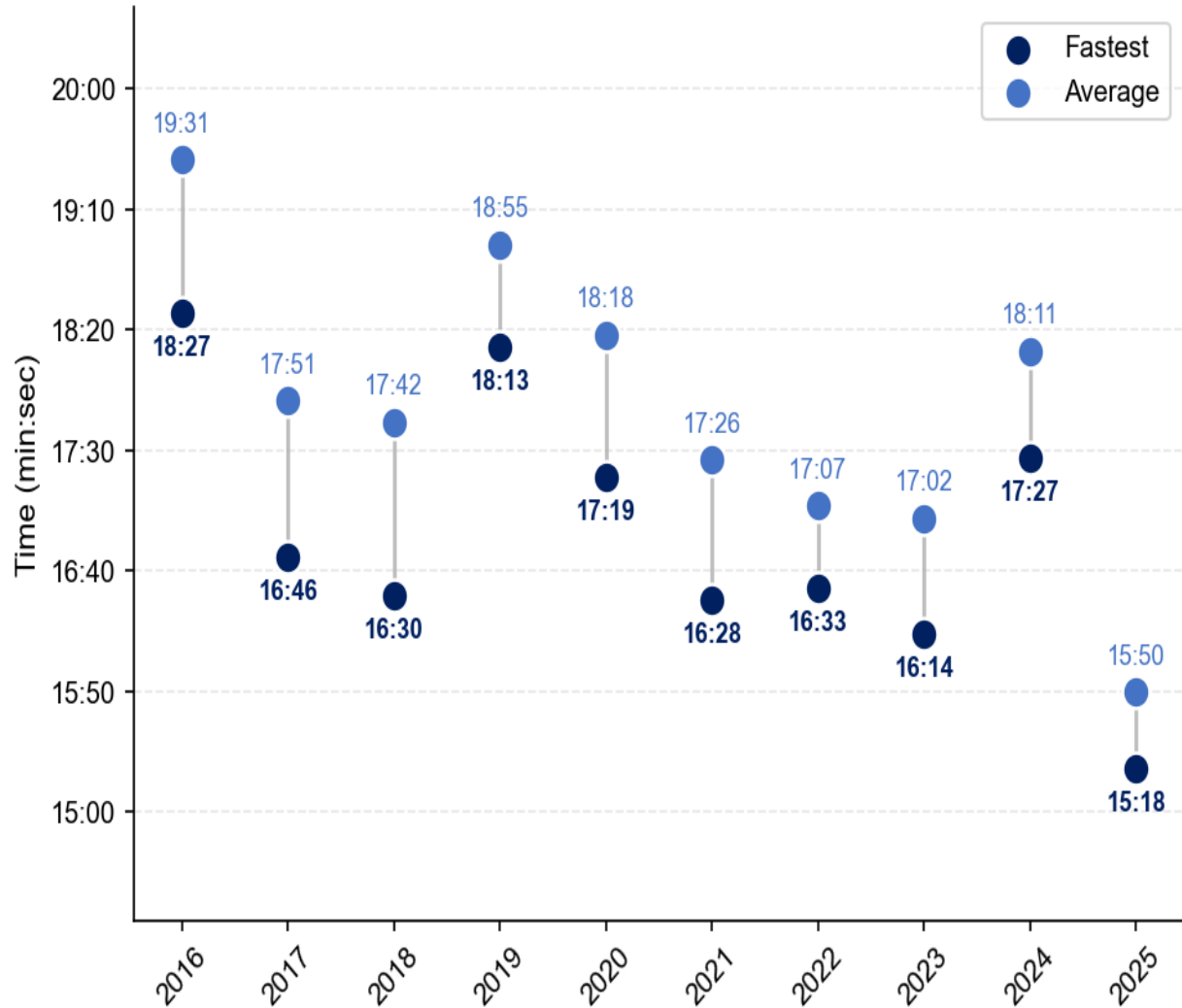
Karlovy Vary



Athletes Within 15 sec of Swim Leader



Fastest vs. Average Swim Time



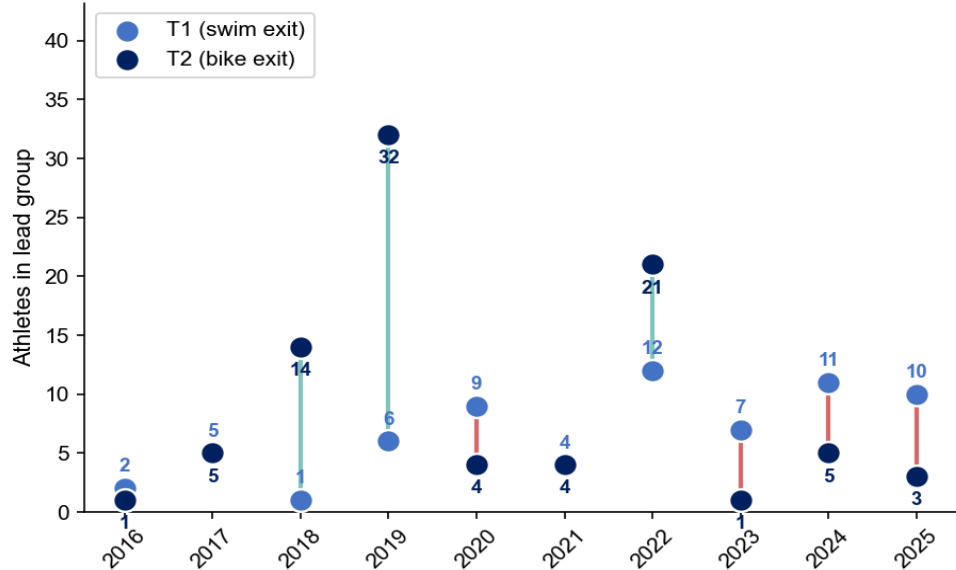
# Bike Pack Evolution — Elite Men

Karlovy Vary

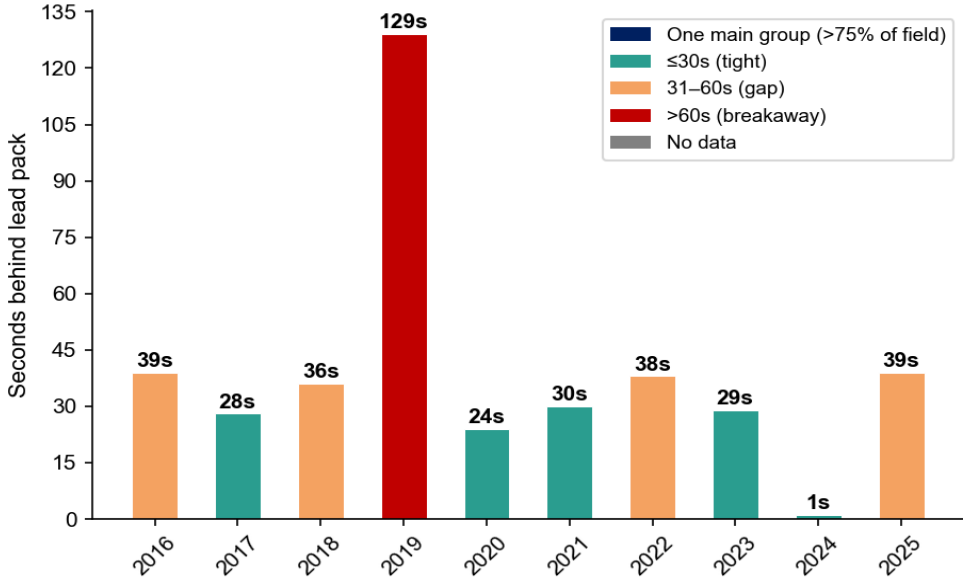


Lead pack = athletes within 15 sec of leader. T1 = lead group entering the bike; T2 = lead group exiting the bike.

Lead Pack Size: Entering T1 vs Exiting T2



Gap: Lead Pack → Chase Group at T2



| Year | Lead Size @ T1 | Lead Size @ T2 | Change | Chase Group @ T2 | Chase Gap* |
|------|----------------|----------------|--------|------------------|------------|
| 2016 | 2              | 1              | -1     | 1                | 39s        |
| 2017 | 5              | 5              | 0      | 4                | 28s        |
| 2018 | 1              | 14             | +13    | 12               | 36s        |
| 2019 | 6              | 32             | +26    | 2                | 129s       |
| 2020 | 9              | 4              | -5     | 1                | 24s        |
| 2021 | 4              | 4              | 0      | 24               | 30s        |
| 2022 | 12             | 21             | +9     | 21               | 38s        |
| 2023 | 7              | 1              | -6     | 9                | 29s        |
| 2024 | 11             | 5              | -6     | 18               | 1s         |
| 2025 | 10             | 3              | -7     | 25               | 39s        |

Lead pack = athletes within 15 sec of leader. Chase group = athletes within 15 sec of the first athlete outside the lead pack. \* Chase Gap = seconds from the last lead-pack athlete to the first chase-group athlete at T2.

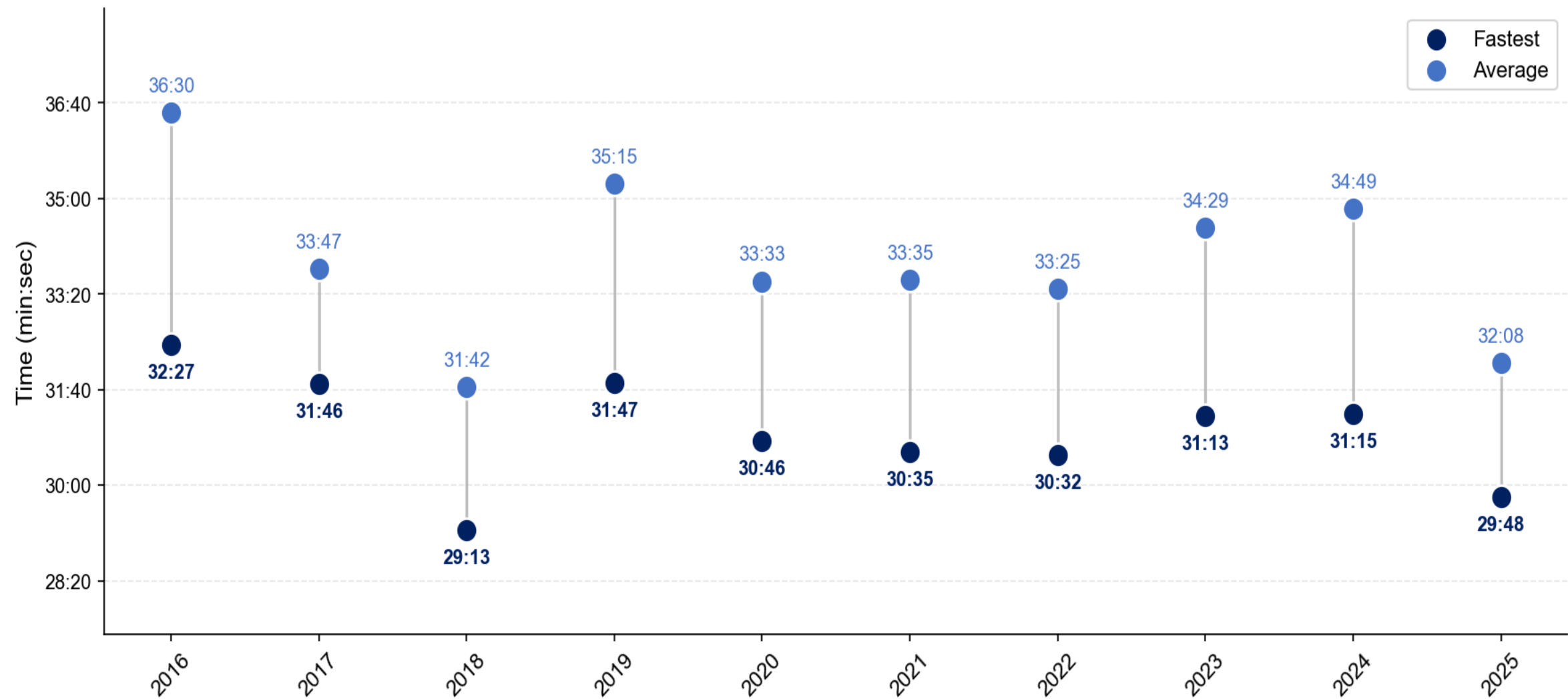


# Run Split Analysis — Elite Men

Karlovy Vary



Fastest vs. Average Run Split by Year

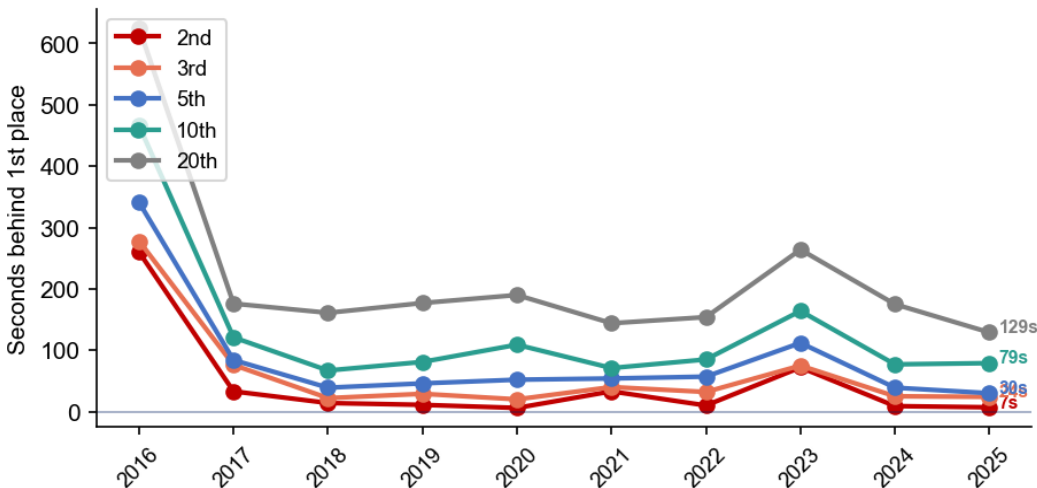


# Key Position Times — Elite Men

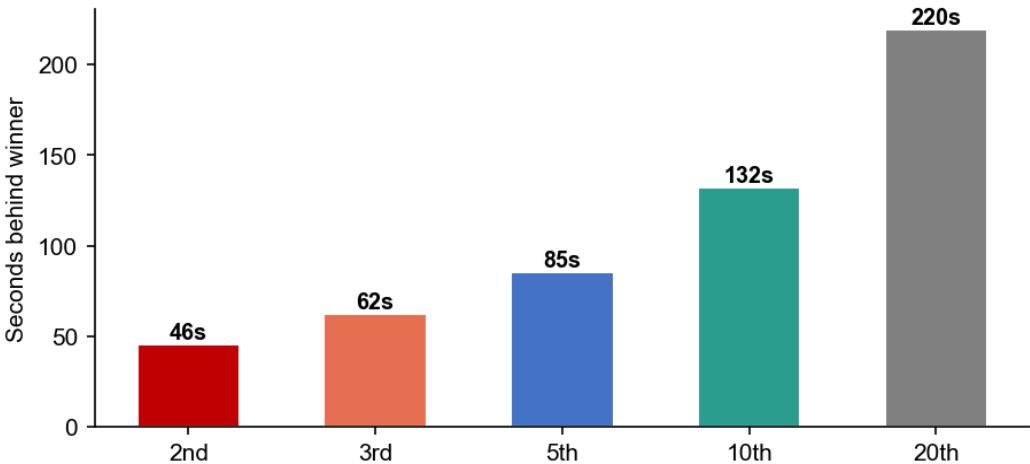
Karlovy Vary



Gap from Winner (seconds)



Avg Gap from 1st Place (all years)



| Year | 1st     | 2nd              | 3rd              | 5th              | 10th             | 20th             |
|------|---------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|
| 2016 | 1:50:34 | 1:54:54<br>+260s | 1:55:12<br>+278s | 1:56:15<br>+341s | 1:58:20<br>+466s | 2:00:59<br>+625s |
| 2017 | 1:49:06 | 1:49:39<br>+33s  | 1:50:22<br>+76s  | 1:50:30<br>+84s  | 1:51:07<br>+121s | 1:52:02<br>+176s |
| 2018 | 1:52:22 | 1:52:36<br>+14s  | 1:52:44<br>+22s  | 1:53:01<br>+39s  | 1:53:29<br>+67s  | 1:55:03<br>+161s |
| 2019 | 1:56:11 | 1:56:22<br>+11s  | 1:56:40<br>+29s  | 1:56:57<br>+46s  | 1:57:32<br>+81s  | 1:59:08<br>+177s |
| 2020 | 1:52:14 | 1:52:20<br>+6s   | 1:52:34<br>+20s  | 1:53:06<br>+52s  | 1:54:03<br>+109s | 1:55:24<br>+190s |
| 2021 | 1:53:31 | 1:54:04<br>+33s  | 1:54:11<br>+40s  | 1:54:25<br>+54s  | 1:54:42<br>+71s  | 1:55:55<br>+144s |
| 2022 | 1:51:10 | 1:51:20<br>+10s  | 1:51:42<br>+32s  | 1:52:07<br>+57s  | 1:52:35<br>+85s  | 1:53:44<br>+154s |
| 2023 | 1:51:55 | 1:53:07<br>+72s  | 1:53:10<br>+75s  | 1:53:47<br>+112s | 1:54:39<br>+164s | 1:56:19<br>+264s |
| 2024 | 1:54:24 | 1:54:33<br>+9s   | 1:54:49<br>+25s  | 1:55:03<br>+39s  | 1:55:41<br>+77s  | 1:57:19<br>+175s |
| 2025 | 1:49:22 | 1:49:29<br>+7s   | 1:49:46<br>+24s  | 1:49:52<br>+30s  | 1:50:41<br>+79s  | 1:51:31<br>+129s |

# Race Conditions — Elite Men

Karlovy Vary



| Year | Date   | Air Temp | Humidity | Wind (km/h) | Precip (mm) | Water Temp | Wetsuit   | Conditions |
|------|--------|----------|----------|-------------|-------------|------------|-----------|------------|
| 2016 | Aug 28 | 25.8     | 52%      | 8           | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2017 | Sep 03 | 14.0     | 59%      | 8           | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2018 | Sep 01 | 15.8     | 60%      | 15          | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2019 | Aug 25 | 24.5     | 59%      | 13          | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2020 | Sep 13 | 21.8     | 50%      | 7           | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2021 | Sep 11 | 18.8     | 81%      | 10          | 0.1         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2022 | Sep 11 | 16.9     | 60%      | 12          | 0.1         | —          | allowed   | —          |
| 2023 | Sep 10 | 27       | 48%      | 4           | 0.0         | 19.8       | allowed   | —          |
| 2024 | Sep 08 | 27.5     | 46%      | 8           | 0.0         | 24.9       | forbidden | —          |
| 2025 | Sep 14 | 19.3     | 81%      | 13          | 0.6         | 18.0       | allowed   | —          |

Air temp, humidity, wind, and precipitation sourced from Open-Meteo historical archive (race window 10:00–17:00 local) where WT API data is absent. Values marked \* are Open-Meteo estimates. Water temp and wetsuit ruling are from the World Triathlon API per program.

# ELITE WOMEN

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# Race Overview — Elite Women

Karlovy Vary



## RACE HISTORY AT KARLOVY VARY

The Elite Women race at Karlovy Vary has been held 10 times in this analysis window (2016–2025). Beth Potter won the first WTCS edition here last year, coming from behind off the bike to close on the breakaway and take the win with the fastest run split of 32:42.

Athletes competing here should expect for the strong swim/bikers to again put the pace on early with the hopes of dropping fast runners like Potter. However, those in the breakaway, should keep in mind the matches they are burning on the repeated climbs and how that will affect their run legs. While significant time can be made on the bike here, the flat run course offers the talented runners an opportunity to chase down athletes who may have over biked.

## 3 KEYS TO SUCCESS

1

Course was short was year with the average time for the standard distance at 17:40. Again, the technical requirements of navigating around an island and bridge along with the Auzzie exit has often strung out the field and resulted in only 5-10 coming out of the water close to the lead.

2

Like the men's races, strong swim bikers in the women's race have also historically used the hilly course to further separate the field. However, where the men's chase group has held the gap relatively close, it has ballooned more so on the women's side. Don't be surprised if a group of less than 5 women are able to put multiple minutes into just the first chase group at T2.

3

The fast and flat run course has suited the top women here. Beth Potter, the '25 winner, ran a 32:42 last year, which was nearly a minute faster than the winner at Yokohama who ran a 33:38. Thus while the race is difficult, the flat urban roads do offer the top runners a great opportunity to pass those who override the bike.

# Results Summary — Elite Women

Karlovy Vary



| Year | Date   | Category                    | Field | DNF/LAP /DNS | Winner       | Winner Time | Air Temp | Water Temp | Swim km | Bike km | Run km |
|------|--------|-----------------------------|-------|--------------|--------------|-------------|----------|------------|---------|---------|--------|
| 2016 | Aug 28 | Continental Cup             | 28    | 6            | Yelistratova | 2:07:22     | 25.8     | —          | —       | —       | —      |
| 2017 | Sep 03 | World Cup                   | 26    | 3            | Backhouse    | 2:03:29     | 14.0     | —          | —       | —       | —      |
| 2018 | Sep 01 | World Cup                   | 46    | 16           | Frintova     | 2:08:22     | 15.8     | —          | —       | —       | —      |
| 2019 | Aug 25 | World Cup                   | 55    | 13           | Frintova     | 2:09:08     | 24.5     | —          | —       | —       | —      |
| 2020 | Sep 13 | World Cup                   | 54    | 19           | Duffy        | 2:05:17     | 21.8     | —          | —       | —       | —      |
| 2021 | Sep 11 | World Cup                   | 50    | 17           | Derron       | 2:06:56     | 18.8     | —          | —       | —       | —      |
| 2022 | Sep 11 | World Cup *                 | 53    | 12           | Periault     | 2:05:04     | 16       | 19.1       | 1.50    | 40.8    | 10.0   |
| 2023 | Sep 10 | World Cup                   | 43    | 8            | Jorgensen    | 2:03:51     | 23.6     | 19         | 1.50    | 40.8    | 10.0   |
| 2024 | Sep 08 | World Cup *                 | 27    | 2            | Kingma       | 2:05:23     | 19.8     | 23.2       | 1.50    | 40.8    | —      |
| 2025 | Sep 14 | World Championship Series * | 39    | 10           | Potter       | 2:02:12     | 14.6     | 18.1       | 1.50    | 40.8    | 10.0   |

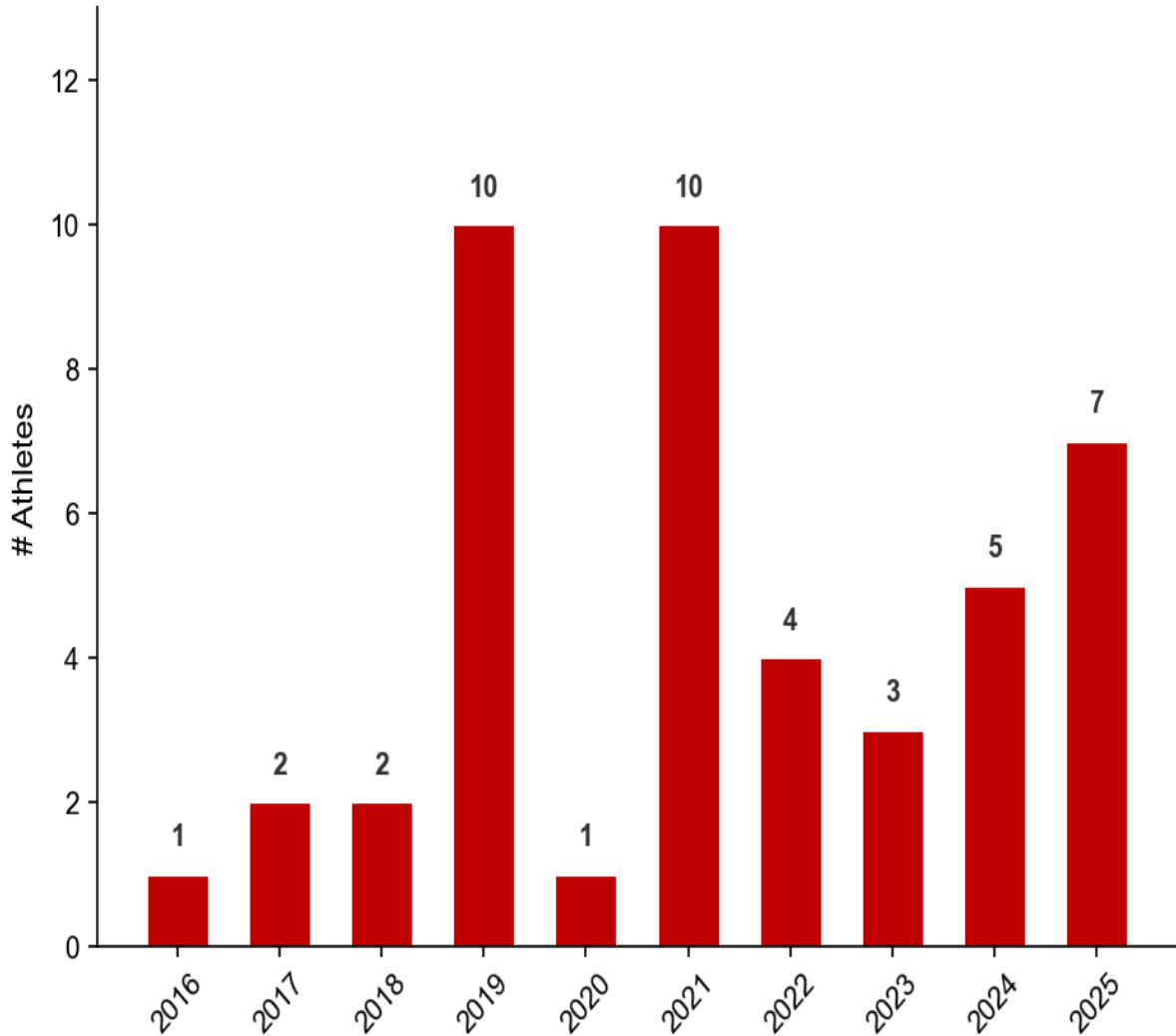
\* Course distance changed vs. prior year

# Swim Exit Dynamics — Elite Women

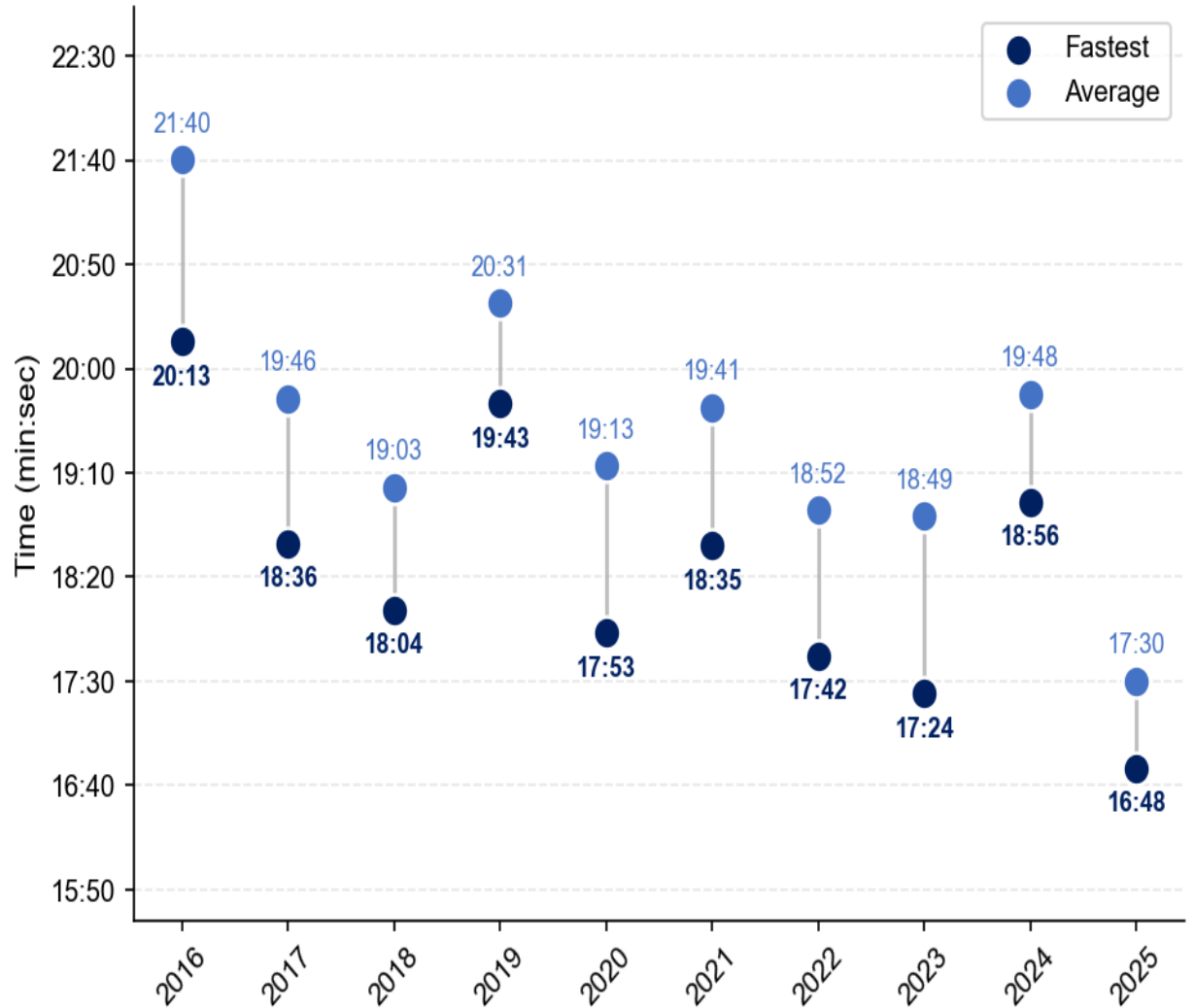
Karlovy Vary



Athletes Within 15 sec of Swim Leader



Fastest vs. Average Swim Time





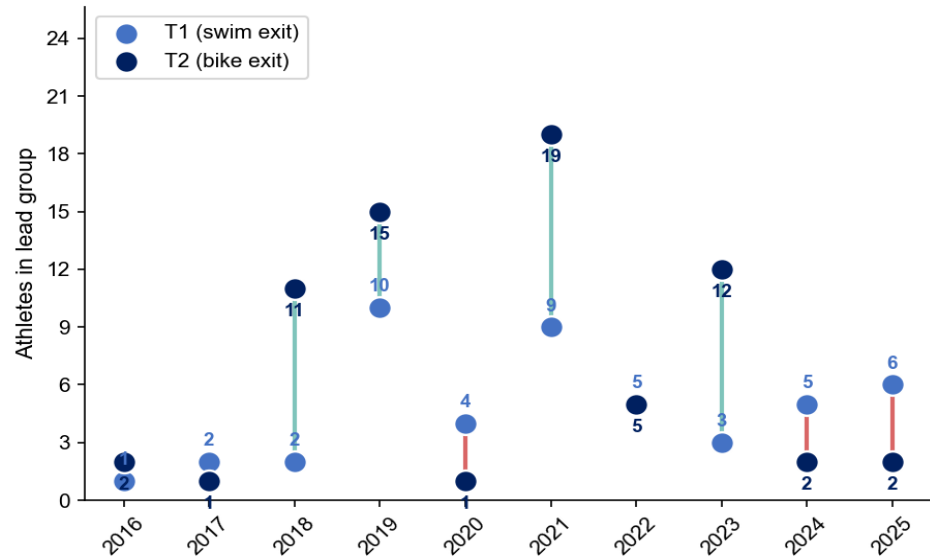
# Bike Pack Evolution — Elite Women

Karlovy Vary

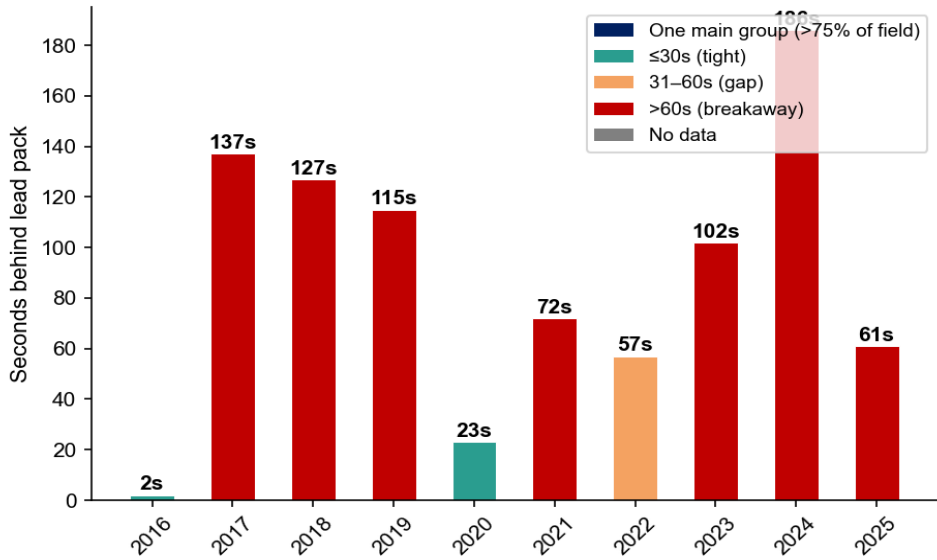


Lead pack = athletes within 15 sec of leader. T1 = lead group entering the bike; T2 = lead group exiting the bike.

Lead Pack Size: Entering T1 vs Exiting T2



Gap: Lead Pack → Chase Group at T2



| Year | Lead Size @ T1 | Lead Size @ T2 | Change | Chase Group @ T2 | Chase Gap* |
|------|----------------|----------------|--------|------------------|------------|
| 2016 | 1              | 2              | +1     | 14               | 2s         |
| 2017 | 2              | 1              | -1     | 12               | 137s       |
| 2018 | 2              | 11             | +9     | 1                | 127s       |
| 2019 | 10             | 15             | +5     | 16               | 115s       |
| 2020 | 4              | 1              | -3     | 6                | 23s        |
| 2021 | 9              | 19             | +10    | 3                | 72s        |
| 2022 | 5              | 5              | 0      | 18               | 57s        |
| 2023 | 3              | 12             | +9     | 14               | 102s       |
| 2024 | 5              | 2              | -3     | 11               | 186s       |
| 2025 | 6              | 2              | -4     | 10               | 61s        |

Lead pack = athletes within 15 sec of leader. Chase group = athletes within 15 sec of the first athlete outside the lead pack. \* Chase Gap = seconds from the last lead-pack athlete to the first chase-group athlete at T2.

# Run Split Analysis — Elite Women

Karlovy Vary



Fastest vs. Average Run Split by Year

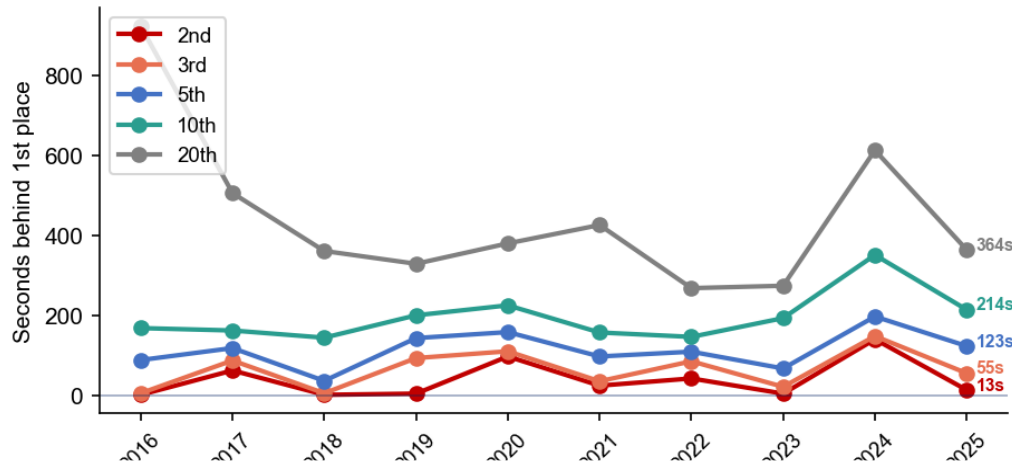


# Key Position Times — Elite Women

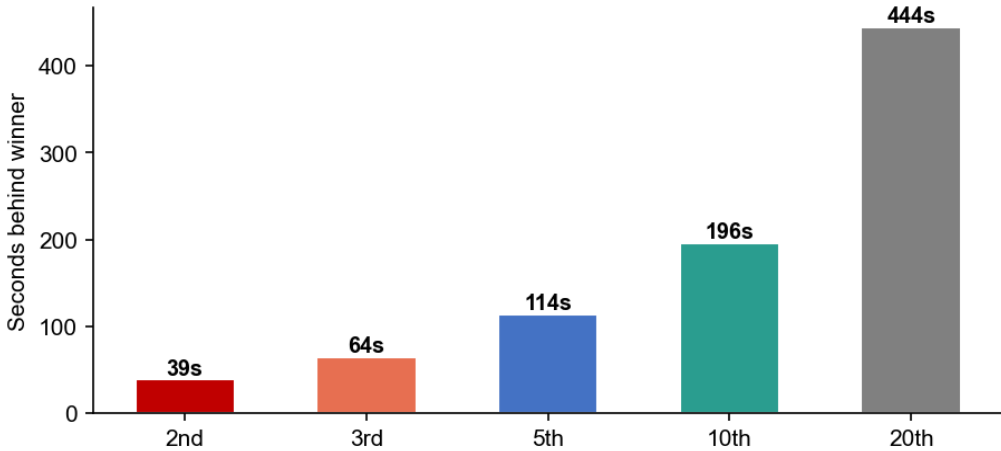
Karlovy Vary



Gap from Winner (seconds)



Avg Gap from 1st Place (all years)



| Year | 1st     | 2nd              | 3rd              | 5th              | 10th             | 20th             |
|------|---------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|
| 2016 | 2:07:22 | 2:07:23<br>+1s   | 2:07:27<br>+5s   | 2:08:50<br>+88s  | 2:10:10<br>+168s | 2:22:46<br>+924s |
| 2017 | 2:03:29 | 2:04:31<br>+62s  | 2:04:56<br>+87s  | 2:05:27<br>+118s | 2:06:11<br>+162s | 2:11:55<br>+506s |
| 2018 | 2:08:22 | 2:08:23<br>+1s   | 2:08:27<br>+5s   | 2:08:58<br>+36s  | 2:10:46<br>+144s | 2:14:23<br>+361s |
| 2019 | 2:09:08 | 2:09:12<br>+4s   | 2:10:41<br>+93s  | 2:11:31<br>+143s | 2:12:28<br>+200s | 2:14:37<br>+329s |
| 2020 | 2:05:17 | 2:06:54<br>+97s  | 2:07:07<br>+110s | 2:07:55<br>+158s | 2:09:02<br>+225s | 2:11:37<br>+380s |
| 2021 | 2:06:56 | 2:07:20<br>+24s  | 2:07:31<br>+35s  | 2:08:33<br>+97s  | 2:09:33<br>+157s | 2:14:02<br>+426s |
| 2022 | 2:05:04 | 2:05:46<br>+42s  | 2:06:29<br>+85s  | 2:06:53<br>+109s | 2:07:30<br>+146s | 2:09:32<br>+268s |
| 2023 | 2:03:51 | 2:03:55<br>+4s   | 2:04:12<br>+21s  | 2:04:58<br>+67s  | 2:07:04<br>+193s | 2:08:25<br>+274s |
| 2024 | 2:05:23 | 2:07:43<br>+140s | 2:07:51<br>+148s | 2:08:40<br>+197s | 2:11:14<br>+351s | 2:15:36<br>+613s |
| 2025 | 2:02:12 | 2:02:25<br>+13s  | 2:03:07<br>+55s  | 2:04:15<br>+123s | 2:05:46<br>+214s | 2:08:16<br>+364s |

# Race Conditions — Elite Women

Karlovy Vary



| Year | Date   | Air Temp | Humidity | Wind (km/h) | Precip (mm) | Water Temp | Wetsuit   | Conditions |
|------|--------|----------|----------|-------------|-------------|------------|-----------|------------|
| 2016 | Aug 28 | 25.8     | 52%      | 8           | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2017 | Sep 03 | 14.0     | 59%      | 8           | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2018 | Sep 01 | 15.8     | 60%      | 15          | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2019 | Aug 25 | 24.5     | 59%      | 13          | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2020 | Sep 13 | 21.8     | 50%      | 7           | 0.0         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2021 | Sep 11 | 18.8     | 81%      | 10          | 0.1         | —          | —         | —          |
| 2022 | Sep 11 | 16       | 60%      | 12          | 0.1         | 19.1       | allowed   | —          |
| 2023 | Sep 10 | 23.6     | 48%      | 4           | 0.0         | 19         | allowed   | —          |
| 2024 | Sep 08 | 19.8     | 46%      | 8           | 0.0         | 23.2       | forbidden | —          |
| 2025 | Sep 14 | 14.6     | 81%      | 13          | 0.6         | 18.1       | allowed   | —          |

Air temp, humidity, wind, and precipitation sourced from Open-Meteo historical archive (race window 10:00–17:00 local) where WT API data is absent. Values marked \* are Open-Meteo estimates. Water temp and wetsuit ruling are from the World Triathlon API per program.